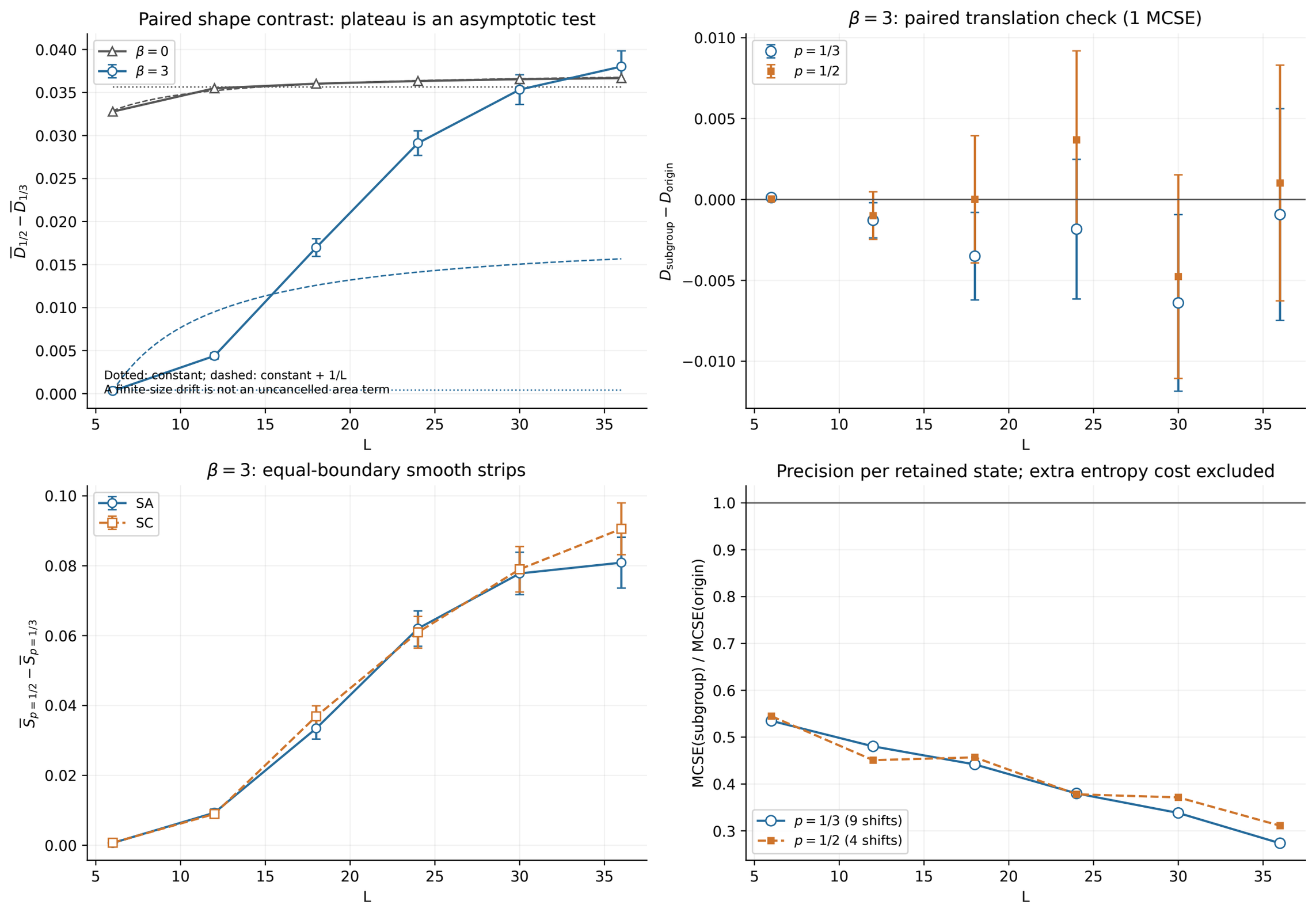
Paired shape contrast: plateau is an asymptotic test
$\beta = 0$
$\beta = 3$
$\overline{D}_{1/2} - \overline{D}_{1/3}$
Dotted: constant; dashed: constant + 1/L
A finite-size drift is not an uncancelled area term
L
$\beta = 3$: paired translation check (1 MCSE)
$p = 1/3$
$p = 1/2$
$D_{\text{subgroup}} - D_{\text{origin}}$
L
$\beta = 3$: equal-boundary smooth strips
SA
SC
$\overline{S}_{p=1/2} - \overline{S}_{p=1/3}$
L
Precision per retained state; extra entropy cost excluded
MCSE(subgroup) / MCSE(origin)
$p = 1/3$ (9 shifts)
$p = 1/2$ (4 shifts)
L